

1964–1969

THE NEW DANDIES

After World War II, the accepted norm for menswear was a double-breasted, three-piece suit, heavy in fabric and loose in fit. With dark blue, grey, or brown as the usual options, and pinstripe the only pattern around, young men simply followed suit. But by the 1960s it was not only women who were revolutionizing their wardrobes. As popular culture took over music and fashion, men also discovered a whole new range of style options. Suits sharpened up their act in subtle ways that had major aesthetic impact. Collars became longer and larger, while belts and ties grew wider. Slimmer fits were now popular, as tailored, single-breasted jackets and tighter trousers showcased the male form. Colour and pattern came in to the alarm of the more conservative. But for a generation of gentlemen finding their fashion feet, it was time to get suited and booted, and ultimately to suit themselves.

Beau Brummell influence Two rock bands of the 1960s named themselves after the Regency dandy as men again became as fashion conscious as women. This young man strikes a pose in his sharp suit accessorized with gloves, cane, and breast-pocket handkerchief.

1965

Contrasting collar colour

Accessories for men

Fitted box jacket

Slim-fitting trousers

Low-heeled smart shoes



1968

Fresh with finesse Designed by tailor Blades, this suit is an example of what happened when the freshness of Carnaby Street's clothing met the finesse of Savile Row's tailoring. Roy Strong wore it while he was director of the National Portrait Gallery.

Relaxing the rules The 1960s saw the arrival of more informal dress codes. Teamed here with a silk rollneck shirt, this casual suit by H. Huntsman & Sons has a noticeably slimmer fit in the trousers and modern tailoring on the jacket.